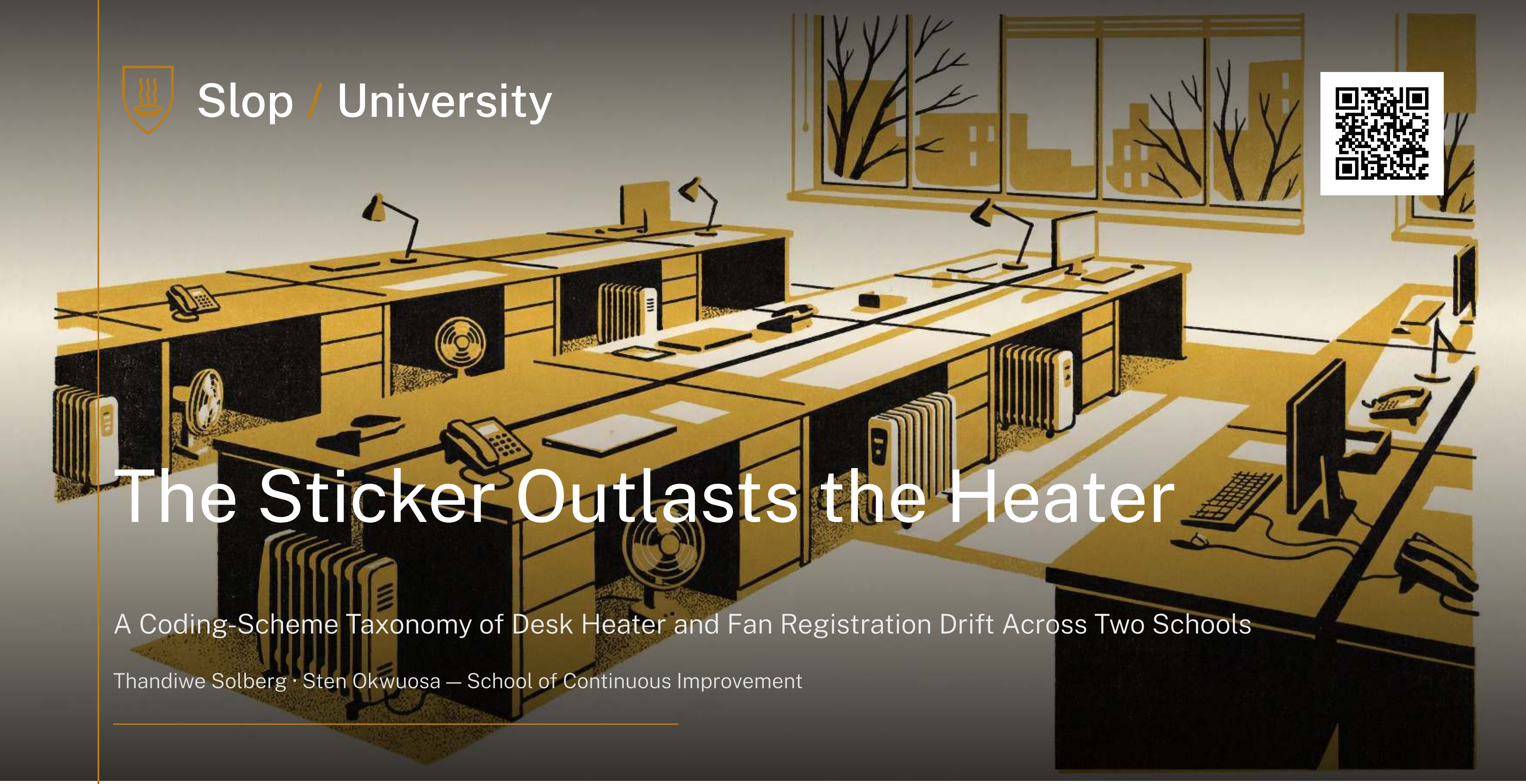
Slop / University



The Sticker Outlasts the Heater

A Coding-Scheme Taxonomy of Desk Heater and Fan Registration Drift Across Two Schools

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Background

Personal Comfort Appliance tags renew every winter, yet Facilities' compliance ledger and what actually sits under a desk diverge as soon as an appliance is unplugged, quietly replaced, or simply removed. How much of the register still describes anything at all?

Aims

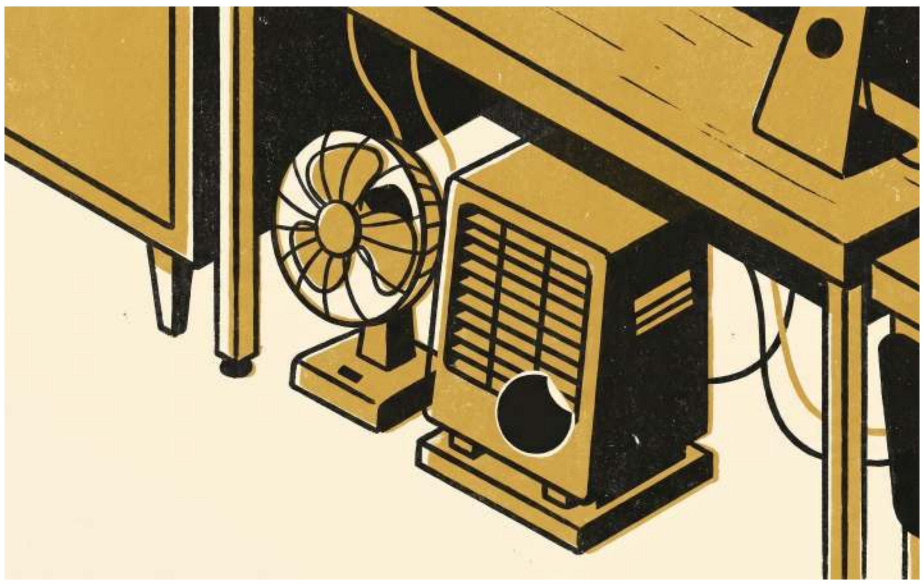
- Classify every personal heater and fan found on a floor walk-through by registration status and physical presence
- Establish how many registered appliances survive their own registration
- Compare category shares across two School buildings

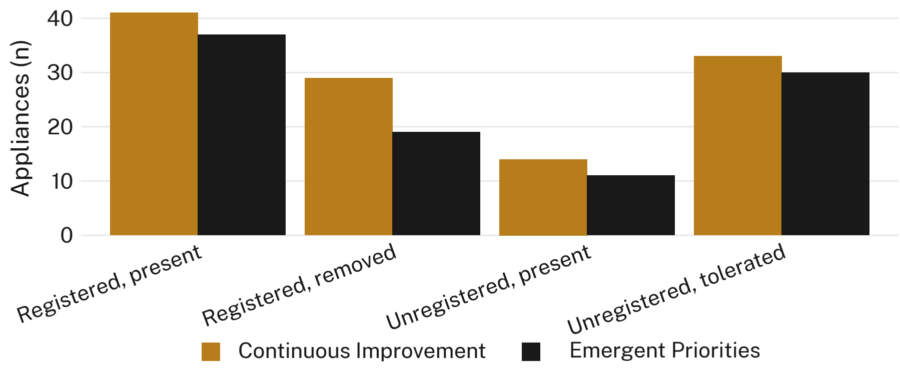
Methods

- n = 214 personal heaters and fans · 8 floors, two School buildings · one winter registration cycle (June–September 2026)
- four-category coding scheme applied independently by two coders on each floor walk-through
- ledger snapshot taken at the 1 September registration lapse; floor coding completed within five working days of the snapshot

Results

Registered and present leads at 36% (78/214). Registered but removed — an active tag, no matching appliance — is nearly twice the size of unregistered and present (48/214 vs 25/214); unregistered but tolerated (63/214, 29%) roughly rivals the compliant category outright.





At the 1 September 2026 lapse snapshot, registered but removed ledger entries (48/214, 22%) outnumbered newly unregistered and present appliances (25/214, 12%) across both schools — the widest gap recorded since the Personal Comfort Appliance ledger's 2019 launch.

Discussion & conclusions

A registration sticker outlives its own referent more often than it tracks it: a fifth of active tags now point at an empty patch of desk. Quiet tolerance, not enforcement, appears to absorb most of what the ledger never captures in the first place, and the two schools sort into the four categories in broadly the same proportions, suggesting a shared floor culture rather than a difference in how either school's coordinators enforce the scheme. Next: track whether tolerated appliances eventually enter the ledger, or whether tolerance is itself the terminal state.

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No appliance was unplugged, relocated, or reported to Facilities for the purposes of this study; ledger entries reviewed for registration status only.